Farshore

Phase 2 / Bibek Pathak / CMPS 4200 HCI

The player advises.

Odysseus decides.

Information architecture, task flows and AI states



Players and design needs

Persona references from the Phase 1 sketches

Maya, 21

Reach Ithaca quickly and understand what changes the score.

Fair scoring, visible consequences and a way to challenge a contradictory interpretation.

Daniel, 19

Experience the poem through play without a technical setup burden.

A clear first turn, plain controls, story context and typing when voice fails.

Rosa, 34

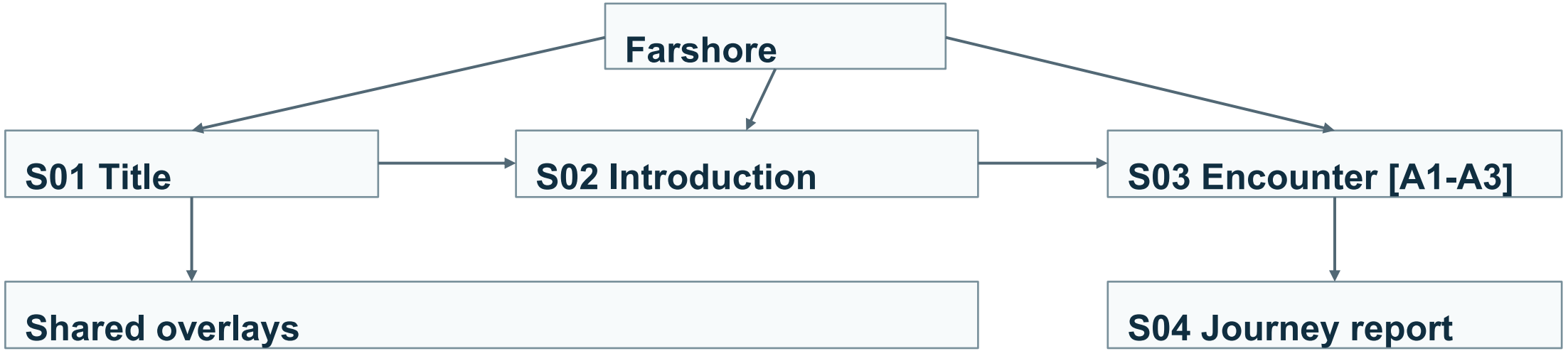
Understand why Odysseus accepts or refuses advice.

Visible AI mode, a short rationale, privacy information and control over questionable results.

Provisional persona sketches. Interview evidence was not supplied.

Screen hierarchy

All current screens and shared overlays

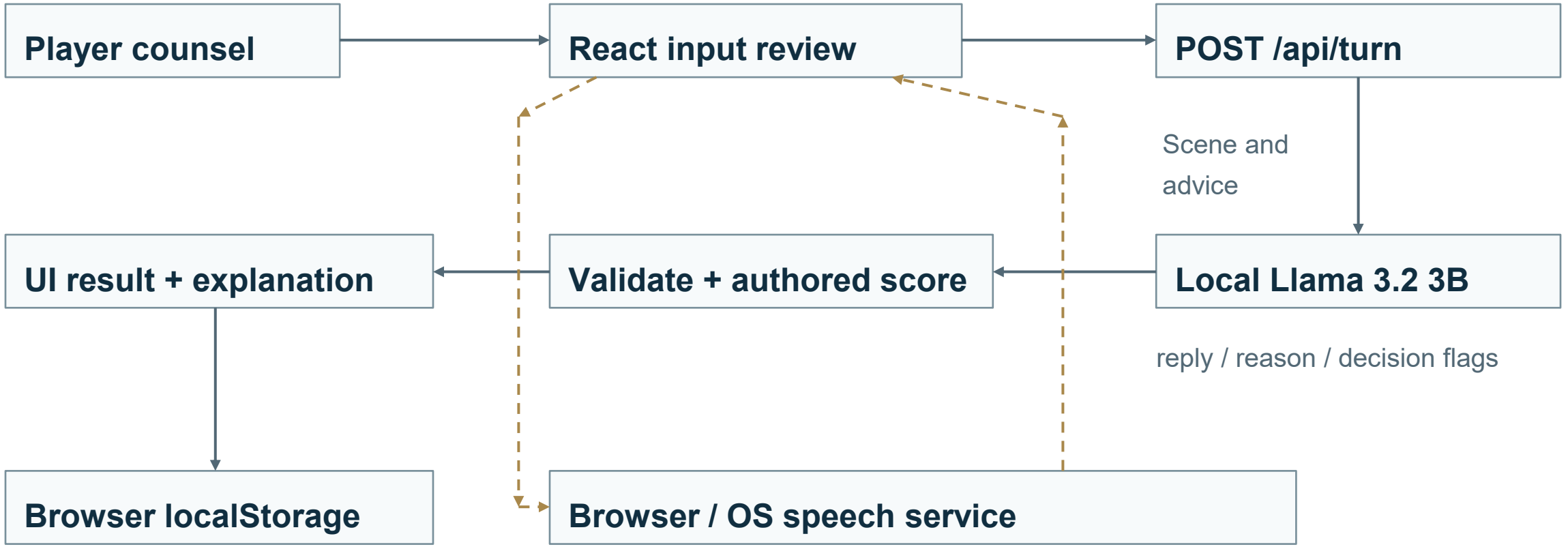


S05 Pause S06 Characters S07 Voyage map
S08 Log S09 How to play S10 Story & sources
S11 Settings S12 New voyage confirmation

Overlays return to their invoking screen. Encounter states include input, processing, review, uncertainty and errors.

Data flow and privacy

Local text inference with separate browser/OS voice services

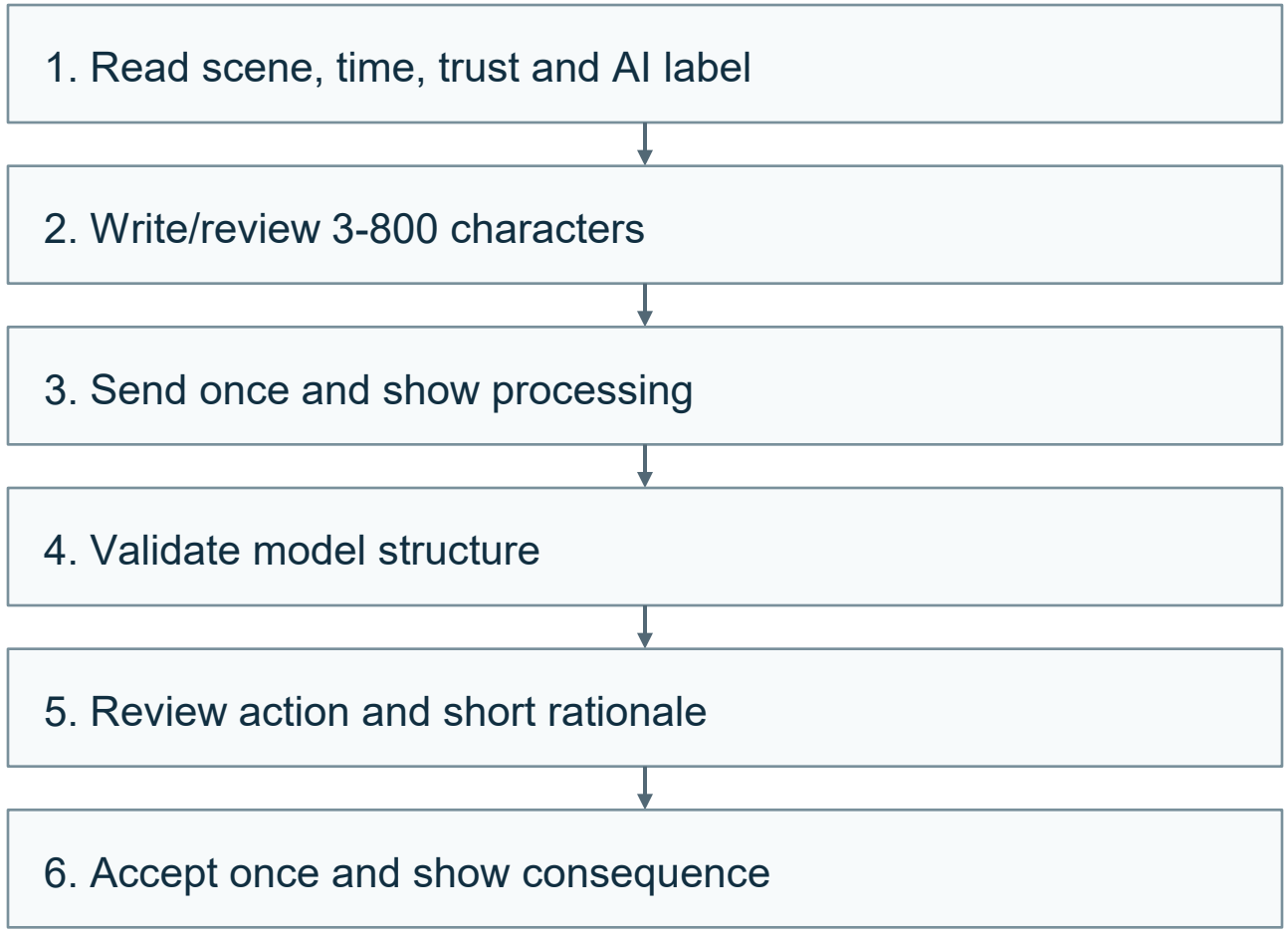


Accepted route, log, time/trust and preferences

Optional audio or reply text may leave the device through a browser/OS voice service. Reviewed transcript returns to React.

F2: Counsel and decision review

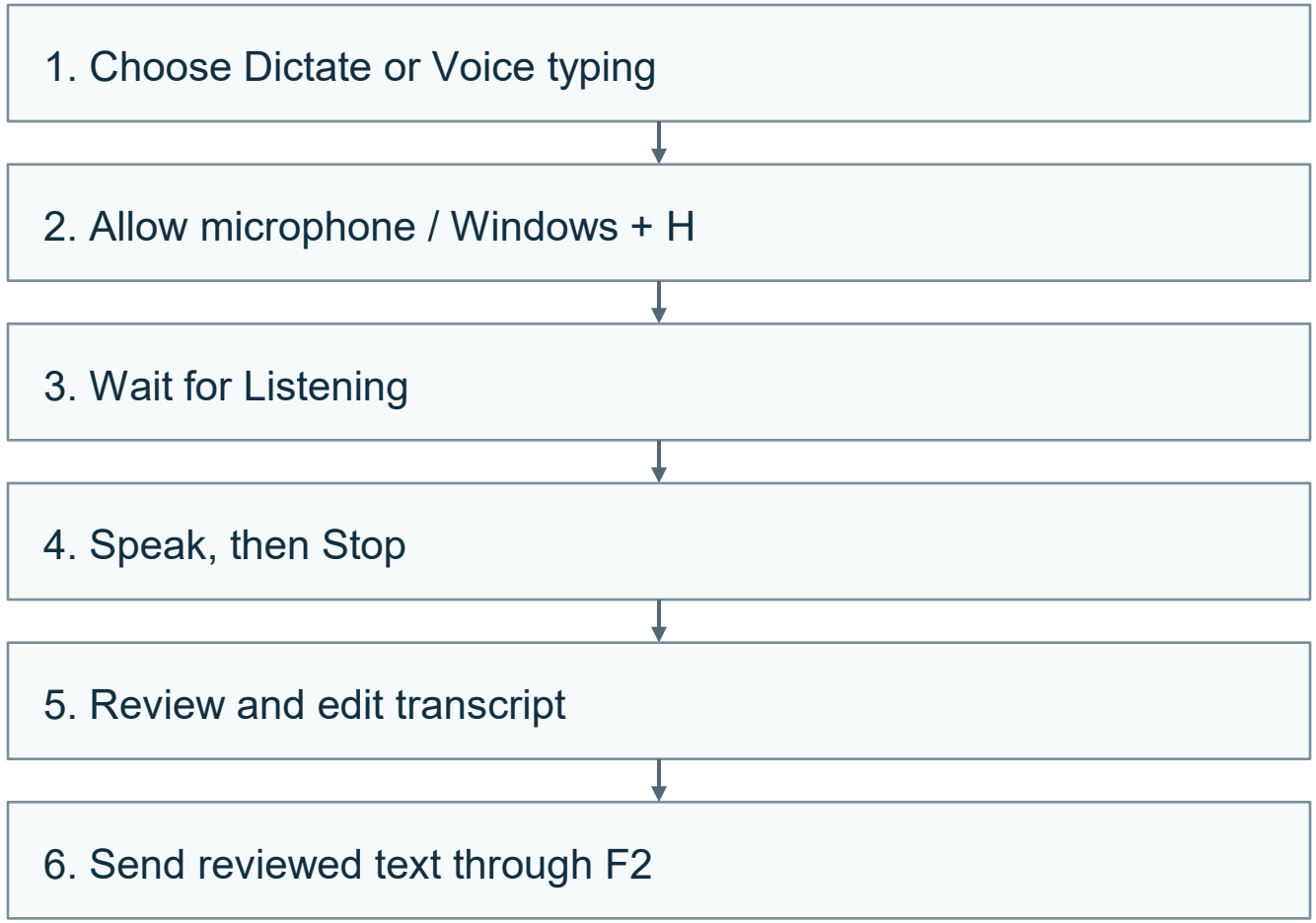
Maya and Rosa / review checkpoint proposed



- Read the action and rationale before scoring.
- Refine or discard a questionable candidate.
- Commit once, then advance the route.
- Current game commits immediately.

F3: Dictation and transcript review

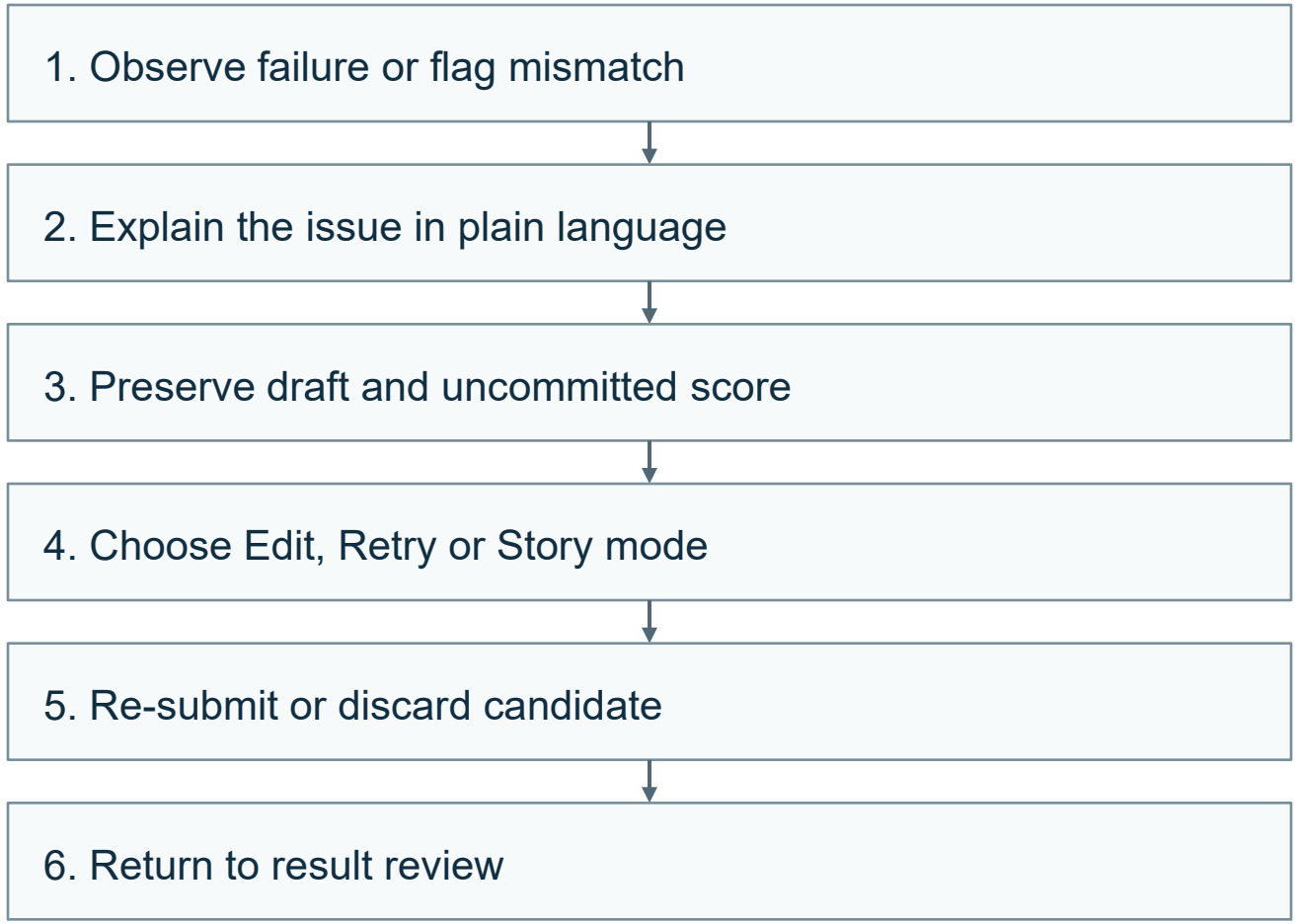
Daniel / typing remains available throughout



- Wait for Listening, then speak.
- Stop and correct the transcript.
- Submit only reviewed text.
- A speech failure offers Type instead.

F4: Error recovery

Maya and Rosa / failed turns preserve counsel and score



- Connection error, timeout or rate limit: retry or Story mode.
- Invalid input: explain the required length inline.
- Wrong or empty reply: reject or review.

AI interface states

Input, long-wait feedback and result review

Initial

- Scene and current mode
- Editable counsel
- Dictate / Send

Loading

- Thinking and elapsed wait
- Draft retained
- Cancel request (proposed)

Success

- Action and rationale
- Preview time/trust
- Accept decision (proposed)

W03-W07 cover all five Llama states. W17-W26 cover optional voice services.

Uncertainty and user control

Proposed review before a candidate changes the score

Review this interpretation

Check the action against your counsel

Refine and retry

Discard result

Use Story mode

- Show rationale and story sources.
- Avoid invented confidence percentages.
- Practice-only undo restores route, log and scores.
- Semantic mismatch detection remains unvalidated.

AI technical spike

Six real Llama calls on this laptop

Min 8.87s Mean 26.36s Max 38.43s

Input	Use case	Seconds	Analytic review
S1	Supportive safe counsel	38.43	Consistent action and flags
S2	Negation with safe counsel	28.95	Negation handled
S3	Polite dangerous counsel	8.87	Risky advice understood
S4	Direct safe counsel	25.43	Followed flag disagrees
S5	Motivated safe counsel	29.38	Followed flag disagrees
S6	Ambiguous counsel	27.14	No action, but followed=true

Single sequential run, first-call loading included. Six valid structures. Three followed-flag disagreements.

Failures and design changes

Actual provider errors and separate client/app failures

Failure	Observed response	Design response
Malformed model JSON	HTTP 400: unexpected EOF	Explain invalid request / preserve draft
Missing model	HTTP 404: model not found	Connection check / explicit Story mode
1ms client deadline	TimeoutError, no received model body	Cancel long waits / retain counsel
One-character counsel	App HTTP 400 before model contact	Inline input guidance

No quota benchmark or API fee. Hardware and speech costs unmeasured.

Current prototype and Phase 2 design

Implemented behavior, proposed controls and remaining human review

Implemented

- Playable 15-chapter game and branches
- Local Llama integration and real evidence
- Editable counsel, explanations and retry

Proposed

- Elapsed waits and request cancellation
- Unscored review, refine and discard
- Practice undo and uncertainty states

Before submission: review contributions, collect peer critique and verify the solo arrangement.

Personas remain provisional.